

040. Chapter 3 Verses 38-39

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.38

धूमेनाव्रियते वह्निर्यथादर्शो मलेन च ।
यथोल्बेनावृतो गर्भस्तथा तेनेदमावृतम् ॥ 38 ॥

*dhūmenāvriyate vahnir yathādarśho malena cha
yatholbenāvṛito garbhas tathā tenedam āvṛitam*

dhūmena—by smoke; **āvriyate**—is covered; **vahniḥ**—fire; **yathā**—just as; **ādarśhaḥ**—mirror; **malena**—by dust; **cha**—also; **yathā**—just as; **ulbena**—by the womb; **āvṛitaḥ**—is covered; **garbhaḥ**—embryo; **tathā**—similarly; **tena**—by that (desire); **idam**—this; **āvṛitam**—is covered

As fire is enveloped by smoke, as a mirror by dust, as an embryo by the amnion, so this knowledge of the Self is enveloped by Kama and Krodha.

VERSE 3.39

आवृतं ज्ञानमेतेन ज्ञानिनो नित्यवैरिणा ।
कामरूपेण कौन्तेय दुष्पूरेणानलेन च ॥ 39 ॥

*āvṛitaṁ jñānam etena jñānino nitya-vairiṇā
kāma-rūpeṇa kaunteya duṣhpūreṇānalena cha*

āvṛitam—covered; **jñānam**—knowledge; **etena**—by this; **jñāninaḥ**—of the wise; **nitya-vairiṇā**—by the perpetual enemy; **kāma-rūpeṇa**—in the form of desires; **kaunteya**—Arjun the son of Kunti; **duṣhpūreṇa**—insatiable; **analena**—like fire; **cha**—and

O Arjuna! Knowledge of the Self is covered by this everlasting foe of the wise in the form of desire, insatiable like fire.